VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF WED OCT 7 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

Crew-12 splashes down, Starlink signs up whole airlines, and Elon Musk takes his India fight public

The Dragon capsule Freedom splashed down off Los Angeles at 11:34 a.m. EDT Thursday, bringing four Crew-12 astronauts home after 237 days at the International Space Station (ISS). Starlink had a strong day with airlines: American Airlines will put it on its entire mainline fleet of more than 1,000 jets, KLM will offer it free on long-haul flights from mid-2027, and Royal Air Maroc became the first African airline to sign on.

In India, Elon Musk accused "certain oligarchs" of blocking Starlink's license, and the government called the claim baseless. On Wall Street, a report that SpaceX is seeking about $40 billion of debt to buy Nvidia chips helped push SPCX down 2.51% to $167.60 on Wednesday, ending a three-day run. In Washington, the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) put two direct-to-device spectrum proposals on its October 29 agenda. SpaceX has filed nothing new with the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) since Wednesday morning.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

Crew-12 is home after 237 days

Dragon Freedom undocked Wednesday morning and landed in the Pacific on Thursday; a Space Development Agency launch and the next station cargo run follow within days.

> *LIVE: After 237 days and 100 million miles in orbit, Crew-12 is returning to Earth. Watch with us as they splash down in the Pacific at 11:34am ET (1534 UTC).*
>
> NASA · @NASA · Thursday, October 8



Crew-12 (from left): Andrey Fedyaev, Jack Hathaway, Jessica Meir and Sophie Adenot head to the pad on launch day, Feb. 13, 2026.
PHOTO: NASA/CORY S. HUSTON · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Splashdown off Los Angeles

Freedom undocked from the station at 8:05 a.m. EDT Wednesday and splashed down at 11:34 a.m. EDT Thursday, NASA said. Aboard were NASA astronauts Jessica Meir and Jack Hathaway, European Space Agency (ESA) astronaut Sophie Adenot and Roscosmos cosmonaut Andrey Fedyaev. SpaceX posted "Splashdown of Dragon confirmed!", and Elon Musk (@elonmusk) replied "Welcome home!"

Space Development Agency launch slips to Saturday

> *"Now targeting no earlier than October 10 for Falcon 9 to launch @SemperCitiusSDA's fourth Tranche 1 data transport mission. The rocket and payload remain healthy, and additional time allows for double checks on vehicle systems and range deconfliction"*
>
> SPACEX · @SPACEX · POST, WED 8:34 P.M. EDT

The mission carries 21 satellites for the Space Development Agency (SDA) Transport Layer from Vandenberg Space Force Base in California. The new target is 3:29 a.m. EDT Saturday, October 10. **Date change:** the launch had been set for early Friday, October 9; the FAA's launch advisory issued Thursday still showed that 3:36–4:41 a.m. EDT window, with Saturday as the backup. SpaceX's stated reason is the double checks and range deconfliction quoted above. Before that, an automatic abort on October 5 was followed by delays from October 6 and October 8, Spaceflight Now reported.

Next station cargo: Tuesday

NASA set the 35th Commercial Resupply Services mission (CRS-35) for no earlier than (NET) 6:33 a.m. EDT Tuesday, October 13, carrying more than 6,300 pounds, including the final pair of ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays (NASA).



Technicians at Kennedy Space Center lower a pair of ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays onto a platform on Aug. 11, 2026, ahead of their launch on CRS-35.
PHOTO: NASA/CLAYTON ROUGELOT · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Starship @NASASpaceflight

Ship 40, which flew Flight 13 in July and made the first intact ocean landing, was returned to Starbase Wednesday morning. The outlet also posted its latest unofficial schedule:

> *"Starship (unofficial) schedule latest: Flight 15 (Starbase Pad 2) - NET November 8. Flight 16 (Potentially KSC 39A) - NET December 10."*
>
> NASASPACEFLIGHT · @NASASPACEFLIGHT · POST, THU 10:59 A.M. EDT

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

Three Falcon 9s in four days; Starship eyes November

Every launch and landing on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern Daylight Time (EDT); date changes are noted under each mission.

DATE / TIME (EDT)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Sat Oct 10, 3:29 a.m.	Falcon 9	SDA Tranche 1 Transport Layer A, 21 satellites (fourth of six); booster B1103, 6th flight. **Moved** from Fri Oct 9 for vehicle double checks and range deconfliction (SpaceX); aborted Oct 5	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	CONFIRMED	SpaceX post (Wed); Spaceflight Now; FAA advisory backup window 3:29–4:34 a.m.
Mon Oct 12, 7:00 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-25, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1088, 20th flight. **Moved** from Oct 10 and 11 (first Sep 30); no reason given	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	TENTATIVE	Spaceflight Now (updated Oct 8); Launch Library 2
Tue Oct 13, 6:33 a.m.	Falcon 9 / Cargo Dragon	CRS-35 to the ISS, more than 6,300 lb; booster B1096, 8th flight; docking Thu Oct 15	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	CONFIRMED	NASA; Spaceflight Now; FAA advisory window 6:24–7:14 a.m.
Thu Oct 15, 7:44 p.m.	Falcon 9	USSF-481, US Space Force	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	TENTATIVE	Launch Library 2; Next Spaceflight
NET late October	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 rideshare	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	PRELIMINARY	Launch Library 2; Next Spaceflight
NET November	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	PRELIMINARY	Launch Library 2; Next Spaceflight
NET Sun Nov 8	**Starship**	**Flight 15**	**Pad 2, Starbase, Texas**	PRELIMINARY	**NASASpaceflight unofficial schedule (Thu); Launch Library 2 lists Q4 2026**
NET Thu Dec 10	Starship	Flight 16	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	PRELIMINARY	NASASpaceflight unofficial schedule (Thu)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than month or an unofficial target. Sources: SpaceX on X; Spaceflight Now launch schedule; Launch Library 2 (The Space Devs); Next Spaceflight; NASA; Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) Air Traffic Control System Command Center operations plan advisory 041, issued 11:38 a.m. EDT Thursday. That advisory still

listed the SDA mission's earlier primary window, Fri Oct 9, 3:36–4:41 a.m. EDT, and the Starlink 15-25 window from Sat Oct 10, 7:00–11:43 p.m. EDT, both since superseded. Times for the later missions from those two schedules are unofficial. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

Starship status

Starship last flew on Flight 14 in late September, splashing down north of Hawaii (Spaceflight Now). The next two flights have no FAA launch dates yet; the November 8 and December 10 targets come from an unofficial schedule posted by NASASpaceflight. Flight 16 would be the first from Florida if it uses Launch Complex 39A. Separately, the FAA is studying Starship launches from Space Launch Complex 37 at Cape Canaveral (Section VI).



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 40 with Crew-12 on Feb. 13, 2026. CRS-35 is set to launch from the same pad on Tuesday.

PHOTO: NASA/CORY S. HUSTON · PUBLIC DOMAIN

III · STARLINK

Three airlines in two days

American goes fleet-wide, KLM makes it free, Royal Air Maroc brings it to Africa, and the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) clears a much larger direct-to-cell network.

1,000+	1 Gbps	15,000	$100
American Airlines mainline jets to get Starlink, installs from early 2027	Peak speed per Performance Aero Terminal, per American	Next-generation direct-to-cell satellites approved by the FCC on October 6	New Starlink referral reward, to both the referrer and the friend

American Airlines: every mainline jet

American said Thursday it will install Starlink across its whole mainline fleet of more than 1,000 aircraft starting in early 2027. That expands a May commitment covering more than 500 Airbus jets. Each Performance Aero Terminal delivers up to 1 gigabit per second (Gbps).

> *"Starlink will deliver fast, reliable connectivity across @AmericanAir's full mainline fleet so passengers can stream, game, work, and stay connected to family and friends throughout their travel"*
>
> STARLINK · @STARLINK · POST, THU 9:46 A.M. EDT

KLM and Royal Air Maroc

KLM announced free high-speed Starlink Wi-Fi on intercontinental flights from mid-2027, rolling out in phases through mid-2028; CEO Marjan Rintel said it will keep passengers connected over oceans and remote routes. Musk posted "Starlink coming to KLM!" A day earlier, Royal Air Maroc said it will be the first African airline with Starlink, starting in 2027.

Stephanie Bednarek @SRBednarek · vice president of commercial sales, SpaceX

Starlink Mobile, the direct-to-cell service, launched in Bangladesh with the carrier Banglalink on Wednesday.

> *"We're now connecting millions of people in Bangladesh with Starlink Mobile! Our technology provides an additional layer of connectivity in cellular dead zones so coastal communities, remote businesses, families and travelers can stay in touch no matter where they are."*
>
> STEPHANIE BEDNAREK · @SRBEDNAREK · POST, WED 8:26 P.M. EDT

FCC clears a bigger direct-to-cell network

The FCC approved up to 15,000 next-generation direct-to-cell satellites in very low orbit, plus a waiver letting SpaceX offer service without leasing spectrum from a ground-based carrier, Sawyer Merritt reported, citing PCMag. Musk added (conditions and deadlines are in Section VI):

> *"Starlink Mobile (direct-to-cell) V2 satellites are incredible. This @SpaceX constellation will enable more than 100 times the bandwidth of our current V1 system!"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST, WED 11:21 A.M. EDT

QUICK HIT

Starlink raised its referral reward on Thursday to $100 for both the referrer and the friend, paid as cash or credit after two months of service (details). Rewards vary by market.

IV · THE INDIA STANDOFF

"Is Ambani the real boss of India?"

Musk escalated his complaint over Starlink's stalled Indian license, India's government pushed back, and the opposition leader joined in.

On Wednesday morning, Musk quoted a DogeDesigner post arguing "India needs @Starlink." The post cited 11,256 villages without 4G coverage as of May 2026 and said only 4.26% of homes have wired internet. Musk replied:

> *"Unfortunately, we are being blocked by certain oligarchs in order to maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people. You can guess who they are … This is a crime against the people of India!"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST, WED 11:23 A.M. EDT

Later Wednesday, answering a user who said Starlink terminals had been recovered from insurgents in Manipur, he wrote: "Starlink beams are turned off over India, so the claim that they were used by anyone for any reason is absolutely false."

The government's answer

Officials called the charge baseless and said the licensing process is non-discriminatory. They said Starlink, Eutelsat OneWeb and Jio Satellite are all at the same security-assessment stage, and that spectrum will be assigned after clearance (The Hindu; Economic Times). Business Standard listed three items still pending: security clearance, foreign direct investment approval and spectrum rules.

Thursday: Musk names a name

Quoting Aniruddha Malpani, who wrote that "The government is more interested in protecting the interests of crony capitalists than of citizens," Musk posted:

> *"Starlink is licensed in over 165 countries and has spent five years complying with every single law and requirement of the government of India, so why still no license? Is Ambani the real boss of India?"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST, THU 9:25 A.M. EDT

Rahul Gandhi (@RahulGandhi), Leader of the Opposition in India's lower house, replied: "Welcome to India, Elon. Wait till you discover the other guy." Musk answered: "Thank you, Rahul. This is indeed troubling." He also posted: "People who oppose @Starlink hurt only the least-served. The wealthy or those living in large cities already have good Internet, so they don't understand."

V · AI & COMPUTE

A reported $40 billion for Nvidia chips

SpaceX is said to be lining up debt backed by the graphics processors themselves; neither company has confirmed it.

The Financial Times first reported the talks. According to CNBC, SpaceX is in preliminary discussions with Apollo and several banks on about $40 billion of financing, mostly investment-grade debt, with the graphics processing units (GPUs) as collateral. TipRanks reported a split of roughly $10 billion in bank loans and $30 billion in investment-grade debt. SpaceX sold $25 billion of bonds two weeks after its June initial public offering (IPO) and carried about $40 billion of debt in its second-quarter financials, CNBC said. Its Colossus and Colossus 2 data centers hold about 230,000 and 550,000 chips, with a target of 1.21 million by late December. SpaceX also has computing deals with Google, Anthropic, Reflection AI and Cursor.

On the product side, Musk said most requests to the Grok assistant "are pretty simple and will be handled by a lightning-fast version of Grok 4.8 when that comes out," and, replying to Aaron Burnett (@aaronburnett), CEO of Mach33, wrote "The path to a petawatt/year is mass drivers on the Moon."

QUICK HIT

Morgan Stanley reiterated Overweight, CNBC reported, quoting the note: "The next chapter of the SpaceX story is its role in converting energy (e) into intelligence (i) through physical robots (r) manufactured on/near shore." The target is $300 (Stocktwits).

QUICK HIT

Elon Musk @elonmusk: "Thank you on behalf of the amazing people of SpaceX, Tesla, Neuralink and Boring Company, without whom anything I have done would have been impossible" (Thursday, 11:56 a.m. EDT).

Nothing new at the SEC or FAA; the FCC sets a D2D agenda

The FCC's October 6 direct-to-device license came with deadlines, and the agency added two related spectrum votes for October 29.

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Wednesday and 1:00 p.m. EDT Thursday. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his September 15 report on the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities, made under a Rule 10b5-1 trading plan; it did not change his pecuniary interest. He reports 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — On September 22 she exercised options for 342,170 shares (138,900 at $8.3998, 74,405 at $11.20 and 128,865 at $19.40) and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72, under a Rule 10b5-1 plan adopted June 23, 2026. She holds 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FAA

> No new FAA licenses, license modifications or environmental notices for SpaceX appeared on the FAA's commercial space license pages or in the Federal Register since Wednesday morning. Latest on record:

Notice of intent · Sep 29 — The FAA will prepare a Supplemental Environmental Impact Statement (SEIS) on Starship operations at Space Launch Complex 37: up to 76 launches and 152 landings a year. Public scoping comments close Wednesday, October 14 (docket FAA-2026-10792; 91 FR 61551). Federal Register · FAA

FCC

New · Oct 7 · Open-meeting agenda — FCC Chairman Brendan Carr set two votes for October 29: a notice of proposed rulemaking to make 482 MHz more spectrum eligible for Supplemental Coverage from Space (direct-to-device service), and a proposed auction of 25 MHz in the 1675–1695 and 2020–2025 MHz bands, usable for 5G, direct-to-device or both. SpaceX had asked for 2020–2025 MHz; the October 6 order deferred that request. Draft texts were not yet public. Telecompetitor · Broadband Breakfast

Order DA 26-1078 · Oct 6 · docket 25-340 — The Space and Wireless Telecommunications bureaus granted in part SpaceX's 15,000-satellite direct-to-device system. Half (7,500) must be operating by October 7, 2032, and all by October 7, 2035. SpaceX must post a surety bond by November 4 and has 30 days from release to decline the conditioned grant. The order waives the terrestrial-lease requirement and defers the 20.2–21.2 and 30–31 GHz bands. Exterra · Telecompetitor

Takeaways

1. Crew-12 came home safely after 237 days; the SDA launch (Saturday) and CRS-35 (Tuesday) are next.
2. Starlink is becoming standard on airlines: American fleet-wide, KLM free, Royal Air Maroc first in Africa.
3. India is now a public fight; the government says Starlink faces the same clearances as its rivals.
4. The reported $40 billion chip financing weighed on SPCX; the companies have not confirmed it.
5. Watch the share supply: a lock-up tranche of up to 328.4 million Class A shares can be sold from Friday.

SOURCES

X posts from @SpaceX, @Starlink, @NASA, @elonmusk, @SRBednarek, @NASASpaceflight, @AmericanAir, @royalairmaroc, @RahulGandhi, @SawyerMerritt; NASA, American Airlines and KLM newsrooms; CNBC, Spaceflight Now, Launch Library 2, Next Spaceflight, The Hindu, Economic Times, Business Standard, Seeking Alpha, TipRanks, Stocktwits, Telecompetitor, Exterra, Broadband Breakfast; FAA, Federal Register; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain).

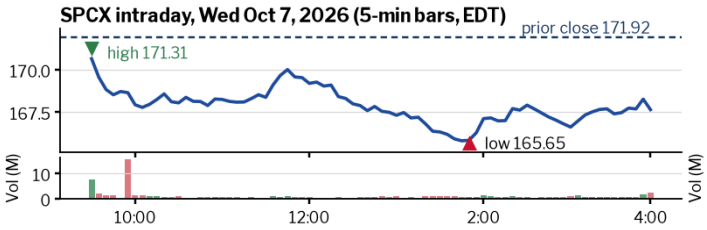
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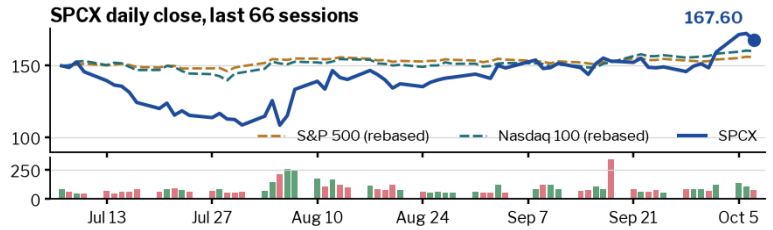
SPCX snaps a three-day run

Shares fell 2.51% Wednesday as space stocks slid on the financing report, a NASA contract delay and rising Treasury yields.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$167.60	−$4.32	$168.13	$171.31	$165.65
Wed Oct 7, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*−2.51% vs $171.92*	*regular session*	*first 5 minutes*	*1:50 p.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**RANGE SINCE IPO**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**SINCE LISTING**
77.13M	$105–$226	$2.21T	+11.10% / +9.21%	+24.1%
−12.3% vs 30-session avg 87.99M	*no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)*	*13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.27T with Cursor shares*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs $135 IPO price; +4.13% vs first close*

SINCE IPO, OCT 7 — low $104.83 · Aug 3 | close $167.60 | high $225.64 · Jun 16 | 50-day avg $142.27





As of close Oct 7, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 7 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**−2.51%**	**+11.10%**	**+9.21%**	**+4.13%**
S&P 500	−0.22%	+1.96%	+1.67%	+4.98%
Nasdaq 100	−0.21%	+2.47%	+5.60%	+5.14%
RKLB	−4.18%	+3.21%	+9.18%	−29.76%
ASTS	−3.91%	+3.04%	−8.27%	−26.40%
IRDM	−1.39%	+0.96%	+1.17%	+2.20%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, THU OCT 8, 12:53 P.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 9	198,264	216,516	1.09	51.8%	$180 / $160
Oct 12	36,067	19,150	0.53	37.9%	$170 / $165
Oct 16	348,827	376,482	1.08	43.7%	$200 / $100
All expiries	**2,300,533**	**2,429,847**	**1.06**		**30-day IV index 47.9**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 8

Strong buy	7
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.78
Mean target (27 analysts)	$224.56 (+34.0%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 15	162.25M
Change vs. mid-August	−12.0%
Short % of float	2.43%
Days to cover	2.07
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.42%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 7 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $1.93)	86.7
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	95.9
Beta	—
50-day average	$142.27 (+17.8%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (14 analysts)	$0.16
Q3 revenue est. (15)	$12.91B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 29	TD Cowen	Buy (initiated)	$200
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235
Sep 28	CLSA	Outperform (initiated)	$250
Sep 14	MoffettNathanson	Neutral	$131 to $142
Sep 8	Wells Fargo	Overweight	$215 to $212

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 9	**Lock-up tranche, up to 328.4M shares; weekly expiry**
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry
Sat Oct 24	Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Tue Nov 3	Q3 results (Yahoo estimate, not confirmed)
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Sat Nov 7	NASA lunar lander (CLPS 2.0) award, postponed
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices, volume, returns and moving averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 7; Yahoo's 3-month average is 92.59M). Consensus, targets, rating actions, short interest (Sep 15), ownership (holders as of Jun 30, % of Class A; FMR 3.93% is third) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Thu Oct 8, 1:33 p.m. EDT. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet: trailing P/E (negative EPS), and beta and the 200-day average (listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) after Wednesday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $167.50 strike; largest positions Oct 16 $100 puts (45,357) and Dec 18 $200 calls (39,360). Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.27T adds 391,041,680 shares from the Aug 14 Cursor merger (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4), Jun 12; a further 1.3B shares unlock two trading days after Q3 results. Why it fell and CLPS date: Seeking Alpha. FCC dates: Exterra.